

S02-01 - The Fallout Investigation

Player read-aloud

The wreck tells a second story. Some damage is animal hunger. Some is not.

Scene summary

The party discovers clues that the strixwolf was not the whole story.

Visible choices

- Inspect body
- Search cart
- Follow tracks
- Move cart

Player questions

- What detail in The Fallout Investigation tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

GM notes

- Give clues generously. The goal is not to hide the ambush forever; the goal is to let players feel clever before the trap springs.
- Keep player-facing information actionable. Reveal systemic truth through objects, reactions, and consequences before naming it.
- Manufactured-threat lens: seed the contradiction, do not explain it. The surface goal stays simple and heroic.

Checks and rolls

- Knowledge Build the incident timeline. Standard Reveal Bramble involvement without flattening motives. 15 Cleanly resolve: Build the incident timeline. Add a concrete boon, extra clue, or improved position. Success, plus the player names one helpful detail or asks one follow-up question. Success, but the GM exposes a cost, ticks a countdown, or reveals a new pressure tied to The Fallout Investigation. The full goal slips, but the party still learns a useful truth or avoids the worst consequence. The GM makes a hard move that follows from the fiction and leaves the next choice visible. Spend Fear to separate true evidence from a tempting false read, or put the carriage/cargo under time pressure. On mixed or sliding results, reveal information in layers: visible fact, actionable clue, then systemic truth.

Clues

- Torn Shipping Seals Cargo was targeted. The Keystone route was leaked. The seal was

cut after the cart stopped.

Loot

- Torn seal
- Route ledger
- Bramble strand
- Tamsin's Home-Token: A small thumb-polished token on a cord hangs beside the torn blue scarf, warm from wear and etched with a tiny house mark instead of a company seal.
- Cracked Pocket Ward?: A cheap little ward charm sits cracked down the middle, still trying to glow through a smiling warranty sticker.

Mechanics

- Plot So Far: The party is in Act Two pressure: The party discovers clues that the strixwolf was not the whole story.
- Mechanics In Play: Use Daggerheart Duality Dice as baseline. Use the listed Difficulty and outcome options when a roll matters. Keep trivial actions no-roll; roll only when uncertainty, cost, or danger is interesting.
- Roll Cards: s02-01-get-the-road-moving-again S02-01 Get the road moving again Get the road moving again Strength Finesse Strength Finesse 12 Strength moves the cart; Finesse fixes the wheel or pin. The Bramble Union watches while the party is exposed. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from the fiction. The Bramble Union watches while the party is exposed. Use a hard...
- Gm Fear Spends: Close the ambush net or put a PC between cargo and a frightened reclaimer. Reveal a personal effect that makes victory emotionally complicated.
- Conditions Hazards: No official condition unless a feature, hazard, or fictional position calls for Hidden, Restrained, or Vulnerable.
- Search Loot Clues: No fixed loot. Offer clue, texture, or hospitality only when the fiction supports it.
- No Roll Guidance: Do not call for a roll when the players have time, a clear method, and no meaningful pressure.
- Escalation: Escalate by making cost visible: time, noise, trust, ward instability, or someone vulnerable in danger.
- Deescalation: De-escalate through respect, care, honest testimony, useful evidence, or a concrete concession.
- Tv Mechanics Caption: Public cue: The Fallout Investigation asks what the party does, what it costs, and who is protected.
- Trait Variety Note: Primary traits in this scene: Finesse, Instinct, Knowledge, Strength. If rolls drift toward Instinct/Presence, ask whether Agility, Strength,

Finesse, or Knowledge better describes the action.

- Class Community Ancestry Reveals: Loreborne: spots older legal, heraldic, or ward-craft language under the branding. Underborne: notices service doors, hidden routes, and who built the thing nobody credits. Highborne: reads etiquette, class panic, and reputational risk. Ridgeborne: notices stonework, weight, pressure, and structural weakness. Wildborne: reads the land, animals, and local ecological stress. Elf/Ribbet/Human/Giant/Katari: invite one sensory or social detail from the player's heritage. Sorcerer/Rogue/Warrior/Guardian/Ranger: give each class one table-facing way to shine without changing the plot.

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